

Dongwoong Seo

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EDUCATION

Paris School of Economics

Ph.D. in Economics

M.A. in Analysis and Policy in Economics

Paris, France

September 2026 -present

August 2026

Yonsei University

M.A. in Economics

B.A. in Economics & B.A. in Applied Statistics

Seoul, Republic of Korea

August 2024

August 2022

University of California, Berkeley

Exchange Student

Berkeley, CA

Spring 2021 - Fall 2021

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Optimal Taxation Theory, Applied Welfare Analysis, Income and Wealth Inequality

WORKING PAPERS

Behavioral Responses to Estate and Gift Taxes: Evidence from Korea (slides)

This paper investigates behavioral responses to estate and gift taxes, using bunching at kinks of the tax schedule. There is no significant bunching along the estate tax schedule, but very sharp bunching along the gift tax schedule. Behavioral responses are larger for close relatives who can exploit gift tax deductions. In line with recent house price rising, the responses have increased.

Missing People and Missing Income: Decomposing Survey Errors in Korea (Jointly with Sehyun Hong, Zhexun Mo, and Li Yang) (slides)

This paper analyzes the misreporting and non-responses in surveys, using Korea's Survey of Household Finance and Living Conditions, linked with administrative data. We find that high-income earners tend to under-report their income, while male respondents and household heads tend to over-report than their true income. This implies that misreporting is a non-classical measurement error.

Estimating the Elasticity of Taxable Income Using Korea's Bracket Creep (slides)

This paper estimates the elasticity of taxable income with respect to the net-of-marginal-tax rate, using Korea's bracket creep and tax reforms. I find that Korea's taxable income elasticity is around 0.34 when controlling for a cubic function of the log initial income. The elasticity estimates tend to be higher for taxable income than for global income. Additionally, business owners responded to tax changes more elastically than wage earners.

Impacts of Public Pension Reforms on Private Savings in South Korea (slides)

This paper evaluates the impacts of Korea's Government Employee Pensions reform in 2015 using difference-in-differences approach. I find that reduced public pension wealth was offset by increased private savings.

Furthermore, the offsetting effect was higher for the younger cohorts, as the reduction level was even higher for them.

PRESENTATIONS

“Missing People and Missing Income: Decomposing Survey Errors in Korea.” *World Inequality Conference*. June 2026. Paris, France.

“Impacts of Public Pension Reforms on Private Savings in South Korea.” *The Joint Economics Seminar of Four Leading Korean Universities*. June 2023. Seoul, Republic of Korea.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Yonsei University

- Teaching assistant for Prof. Kyung-woo Lee: undergraduate Public Finance 2023 - 2024
- Tutor for Eagles Tutoring Program: undergraduate Econometrics (1) Spring 2022

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

POSCO Overseas Fellowship, POSCO TJ Park Foundation 2026 -
· Nationally competitive fellowship for doctoral study abroad

Integrated Undergraduate-Graduate Program Scholarship, Yonsei University 2022 - 2024
· Merit-based full-tuition scholarship for Master’s program

Top School Summer Challenger Fellowship, DB Kim Joon-ki Cultural Foundation 2022
· Funding for attending Harvard Summer School

Excellence Award, Yonsei University Economic Papers Contest 2022
· For “Latent Meritocratic Beliefs and Policy Preferences in South Korea”

Excellence Tutor Award, Yonsei University Eagles Tutoring Program 2022
The Next Century Humanities Scholarship, Korea Student Aid Foundation 2016 - 2022
· Merit-based full-tuition scholarship for undergraduate study in social sciences

SKILLS & OTHER INFORMATION

Computer Skills	R, STATA, python, Matlab, and L ^A T _E X
Language	Korean (native), English (fluent)
Nationality	Republic of Korea

REFERENCES

Antoine Bozio

Professor of Economics, PSE
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Gabriel Zucman

Professor of Economics, PSE and UC Berkeley
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Emmanuel Saez

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Email: saez@econ.berkeley.edu